

SHAKE IT OFF

AND MAKE THE DEVIL TAKE IT BACK

TEXT: [Acts 28:1-5](#) (NKJV) *“Now when they had escaped, they then found out that the island was called Malta. ²And the natives showed us unusual kindness; for they kindled a fire and made us all welcome, because of the rain that was falling and because of the cold. ³But when Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks and laid them on the fire, a viper came out because of the heat, and fastened on his hand. ⁴So when the natives saw the creature hanging from his hand, they said to one another, “No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though he has escaped the sea, yet justice does not allow to live.” ⁵But he shook off the creature into the fire and suffered no harm.”*

[James 4:7-10](#) (NKJV) *“Submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you. ⁸Draw near to God and He will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, you sinners; and purify your hearts, you double-minded. ⁹Lament and mourn and weep! Let your laughter be turned to mourning and your joy to gloom. ¹⁰Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and He will lift you up.”*

INTRO: For far too long the people of God have walked around upset, discouraged, disgusted, depressed, restless, battle fatigued, and running in fear. The reason this has happened is that we have allowed the enemy to harass, agitate, aggravate, humiliate, rob, and lie to us.

I for one, think it is high time you and I as people of God, know our position in God, and realize the power and resources available to us when the enemy tries to over-power us! As believers we are under no obligation to accept all the junk the devil tries to place on our proverbial wagon! We can, shake it off and make the devil take it back!

Notice our text; the Apostle Paul is approaching the end of his earthly journey, however the race is not yet completely over, there are still a few battles to fight before the lights go out!

I. PAUL FACED MANY ADVERSARIES ON MANY OCASSIONS

The path of life for Paul was by no means easy:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Paul was stoned at Lystra for preaching Jesus and healing a cripple man... Paul shook it off and made the devil take it back - [Acts 14:20-21](#) (NKJV) *“Jews from Antioch and Iconium came there; and having persuaded the*

multitudes, they stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing him to be dead.

²⁰*However, when the disciples gathered around him, he rose up and went into the city. And the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe.*

²¹*And when they had preached the gospel to that city and made many disciples, they returned to Lystra, Iconium, and Antioch.”*

- Paul encounters a storm at sea and was shipwrecked, almost perishing... Paul shook it off and made the devil take it back – [Acts 27:42-44](#) (NKJV) *“The soldiers’ plan was to kill the prisoners, lest any of them should swim away and escape. ⁴³The centurion, wanting to save Paul, kept them from their purpose, and commanded that those who could swim should jump overboard first and get to land, ⁴⁴and the rest, some on boards and some on parts of the ship. And so it was that they all escaped safely to land.”*
- Paul was bitten by a poisonous snake on the Island of Malta... Paul shook it off and made the devil take it back... [Acts 28:3-6](#) (NKJV) *“When Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks and laid them on the fire, a viper came out because of the heat, and fastened on his hand. ⁴So when the natives saw the creature hanging from his hand, they said to one another, “No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though*

he has escaped the sea, yet justice does not allow to live.”⁵ But he shook off the creature into the fire and suffered no harm.⁶ However, they were expecting that he would swell up or suddenly fall down dead. But after they had looked for a long time and saw no harm come to him, they changed their minds and said that he was a god.”

Paul was most certainly not afraid to die! 2

Corinthians 5:6-8 (NKJV) “So we are always confident, knowing that while we are at home in the body we are absent from the Lord.⁷ For we walk by faith, not by sight.⁸ We are confident, yes, well pleased rather to be absent from the body and to be present with the Lord.” 2 Timothy 4:6-8 (NKJV) “I am already being poured out as a drink offering, and the time of my departure is at hand.⁷ I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.⁸ Finally, there is laid up for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will give to me on that Day, and not to me only but also to all who have loved His appearing.”

Paul was also not afraid to live! Philippians 1:21

(NKJV) “For to me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain.” When the snake bite on the Island of Malta did not kill him, he prayed for the sick. Many were healed and the entire island came to the saving knowledge of Christ!

Have you ever had the devil to tell you he was going to kill you? I have! That is not a very good feeling, until you begin to realize he can't do anymore than your father will allow! Why? Because we belong to God; we are the children of God; since we belong to God, the Lord will direct our steps and will have the final say, on what the enemy or anyone else will or will not be permitted to do! We should not allow the devil threaten us with Heaven! We need to learn to shake it off and make the devil take it back!

II. THE PATH WE HAVE BEEN CALLED TO TRAVEL WILL NOT ALWAYS BE EASY

The devil will attack us in many ways in an effort to destroy us: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- He will say, “You have sinned too greatly to be forgiven.” If the devil say's we cannot be forgiven then we can be forgiven! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! Isaiah 1:18-20 (NKJV) *“Come now, and let us reason together,” Says the LORD, “Though your sins are like scarlet, They shall be as white as snow; Though they are red like crimson, They shall be as wool. ¹⁹ If you are willing and obedient, You shall eat the good of the land; ²⁰ But if you refuse and rebel, You shall be devoured by the sword”; For the mouth of the LORD has spoken.”*

- The devil will tell us, “If you get saved you’ll never make it.” If the devil say’s we won’t make it, then we will! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! Jude 24 (NKJV) “***Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, And to present you faultless before the presence of His glory with exceeding joy!***”
- The devil will say, “You will surely lose the battle you are fighting.” If the devil say’s we will lose, then we will win! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! Romans 8:35-39 (NKJV) “***Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶As it is written: “For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are accounted as sheep for the slaughter.” ³⁷Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us. ³⁸For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, ³⁹nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.***”
- The devil will say, “The bondage you’re in is for keeps.” If the devil say’s you will never be delivered, then you will be delivered! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! John 8:36

(NKJV) ***"If the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed."***

- The devil will attempt to convince us, "Our work for the Lord will never be successful." If the devil say's we are not going to succeed in our work for God, then we will be wildly successful! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! 1 Thessalonians 5:24 (NKJV) ***"He who calls you is faithful, who also will do it."***
- The devil will tell us he is "Going to ruin us financially." If the devil say's we are going under, then we are going over! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! Psalms 37:23-25 (NKJV) ***"The steps of a good man are ordered by the LORD, And He delights in his way. ²⁴Though he fall, he shall not be utterly cast down; For the LORD upholds him with His hand. ²⁵ I have been young, and now am old; Yet I have not seen the righteous forsaken, Nor his descendants begging bread."***
- The devil will say, "We are never going to get over the loss of a loved one." If the devil say's the grief will never end, then it will! Shake it off and make the devil take it back! Isaiah 61:1-3 (NKJV) ***"The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon Me, Because the LORD has anointed Me To preach good tidings to the poor; He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, To proclaim liberty to the captives, And the opening of the***

prison to those who are bound; ² To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, And the day of vengeance of our God; To comfort all who mourn, ³ To console those who mourn in Zion, To give them beauty for ashes, The oil of joy for mourning, The garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness; That they may be called trees of righteousness, The planting of the LORD, that He may be glorified.”

III. THE PATH TO VICTORY IS NOT THAT DIFFICULT FOR THE CHILD OF GOD

How can we walk in the victory Jesus meant for us?

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Commit our lives to Christ...
- Follow the Lord in water Baptism...
- Establish a daily routine of prayer...
- Read the Word of God on a daily basis...
- Be filled with the Spirit...
- Become a faithful attendee of a full Gospel church...
- Develop wholesome relationships with other Christians...
- Stand on the Word... Luke 4:1-12 (NKJV)
“Then Jesus, being filled with the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness, ²being tempted for forty days by the devil. And in those days He

ate nothing, and afterward, when they had ended, He was hungry. ³And the devil said to Him, “If You are the Son of God, command this stone to become bread.” ⁴But Jesus answered him, saying, “It is written, ‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.’” ⁵Then the devil, taking Him up on a high mountain, showed Him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. ⁶And the devil said to Him, “All this authority I will give You, and their glory; for this has been delivered to me, and I give it to whomever I wish. ⁷“Therefore, if You will worship before me, all will be Yours.” ⁸And Jesus answered and said to him, “Get behind Me, Satan! For it is written, ‘You shall worship the LORD your God, and Him only you shall serve.’” ⁹Then he brought Him to Jerusalem, set Him on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to Him, “If You are the Son of God, throw Yourself down from here. ¹⁰“For it is written: ‘He shall give His angels charge over you, To keep you,’ ¹¹“and, ‘In their hands they shall bear you up, Lest you dash your foot against a stone.’” ¹²And Jesus answered and said to him, “It has been said, ‘You shall not tempt the LORD your God.’” ¹³Now when the devil had ended every temptation, he departed from Him until an opportune time.”

The devil will huff and puff and blow against your house, but remember he's a blow-hard! Someone said, *"Fear knocked on the door, faith answered and no one was there!"* Shake it off and make the devil take it back!